

Scammed!

Characters:

Anirudh: Indian male about 26 year old

Entities: Unknown Humanoids

INT. ROOFTOP ROOM - EVENING

The scene opens with our main character taking a power nap on his desk. A Landline phone on his right. Mobile phone on his left.

His Mobile rings. He looks up and sees the caller ID: Supervisor sir

He jumps up, clears his throat and picks up the call.

SUPERVISOR

Hello! Anirudh, where are you? Tum abhi tak Clocked-in kyon nhi ho? 6:30 shift start hai na tumhara? Hello! Anirudh, where are you? Why haven't you Clocked-in yet? Your shift starts at 6:30 right?

ANIRUDH

Hello, Yes sir. Mai bus Clock-in kar hi rha tha. Thoda late ho gaya sorry.
Hello, Yes sir. I was just about to clock-in. Sorry, Got a bit late.

Starts fiddling with the PC

SUPERVISOR

Starting late on the first day itself? Please decide if you want to do this job or not. Because if the targets are not met you know there will be consequences, right?

ANIRUDH

Really sorry sir. I won't be repeating this sir. I want this job.

SUPERVISOR

You better not repeat this. There really won't be a second time. I will make sure of it.

ANIRUDH

I get it, totally. This is the last time this happened.

SUPERVISOR
We'll see. Regardless, before you start, let me make sure you know what you are doing, okay?

ANIRUDH
Sure sir. Please go ahead.

SUPERVISOR
Okay, what is your identity for this job?

ANIRUDH
I am Inspector Vijay from Cybercrime Division of National Investigation Bureau.

SUPERVISOR
Right, and you remember your training on how to use the Marauder Script?

ANIRUDH
Yes sir. It is really simple. I can handle it.

SUPERVISOR
Do NOT screw this up, with that overconfidence.

ANIRUDH
Of course not, sir. I am prepared.

SUPERVISOR
Fine... you may continue.

ANIRUDH
Sure sir. I will start right away.

Call Disconnects. Anirudh puts his phone down and Clocks-in. Then opens the CRM for the job.

Anirudh downloads a csv style file that lists targets for him for today.

ANIRUDH
Alright. Here we go.

Anirudh says to himself as he cracks his fingers. Pick the first target in the list. Dials the number using a CRM tool. The call connects after a few seconds.

ANIRUDH
Hello, main Inspector Vijaya bol rha hu National Bureau of Investigation ke Cybercrime Division se. Kya meri baat Mr. Sahaj Patel se ho rhi hai?

CALLEE

Ji mera naam hi Sahaj Patel hai.

ANIRUDH

Mr. Patel aap meri baat dhyaan se sunein aur call disconnect na karein. Isse pehle mai call ka reason bataun, mai aapse kuch basic details confirm karunga.

CALLEE

Kya matlab hai iska? Aap kya details confirm karenge?

ANIRUDH

Ye phone number 9810000005 aapka hi personal number hai right? Aur aapka address Ananda Vihaar, New Delhi ka hai.

CALLEE

Ji, par aap ye sab kyon mujhe bata rhe hain.

ANIRUDH

Patelji, ek investigation me ek overseas Bank account saamne aaya hai jisse ki aapka phone number aur PAN number linked hai.

CALLEE

(Voice raising)

Kya baat kar rhe hain? Kaun sa account? Mera koi overseas account nhi hai.

ANIRUDH

Sun toh lijiye poori baat. Humare records ke mutabik apka hi phone aur PAN number linked hai uss account se. And uspe 15 crore se jyada ke fraud transactions hue hain.

CALLEE

(Defensively)

Aise kaise maan le aapki baat. 15 crore majak hai? Itna bada amount aaj tak suna nhi humne, aap keh rhe hain mere account me hai?

ANIRUDH

Calm down Mr. Patel. Please let me try to help you. I would request you to kindly cooperate so that we can determine if there has been a case of identity misuse.

CALLEE

Please sir! Tell me what to do.

ANIRUDH

Take it easy. I am opening a verification request on your behalf, okay? If your details match then I may be able to note your cooperation in this case. Am I clear?

CALLEE

(Sobbing)

Yes sir please!

ANIRUDH

Alright, is your full name Sahaj Kumar Patel?

CALLEE

Yes, it is.

ANIRUDH

What is your Date of Birth?

CALLEE

1st January, 1800.

ANIRUDH

Great. Now you will receive a message and a unique code. I want you to read it out loud so that I can match it with the verification code on my end. Okay?

CALLEE

Yes sir.

Anirudh initiates Marauder Script

ANIRUDH

If you received the code please read it out loud.

CALLEE

Six Four Seven One One Five

ANIRUDH

You have been very cooperative Mr Patel. I am submitting your case for a secondary review. Meanwhile I want you to do something. Listen carefully, as soon as this call ends, please put your phone on Airplane mode or switch it off. DO NOT make any calls or receive any calls. It will only complicate matters further. Do you understand?

CALLEE

Yes sir, I understand. How long should I keep my phone like that?

ANIRUDH

Keep it that way for at least 24 hours. It would be better for your case. Any further contacts with you will be through formal channels.

CALLEE

Alright sir, I understand.

ANIRUDH

Very well Mr Patel. Take care. And do not worry.

CALLEE

Okay, thank you so much.

Satisfied. Anirudh hangs up. Marks lead as Collection in Progress. Celebrates quietly. And looks at the next lead.

He checks the number and enters it in the Dialer. Pauses for a second. Takes a deep breath and hits Dial.

CALLEE

Hello?

ANIRUDH

Hello, this is Inspector Vijaya Speaking from the Cybercrime Division of National Bureau of Investigation. Am I speaking to Mr. Gopiraj?

CALLEE

This is his son speaking. What do you want?

ANIRUDH

May I speak to Mr. Gopiraj please? This is really important.

CALLEE

(Sternly)

No, you may speak to me instead. My father is busy at the moment.

ANIRUDH

Can I get your name please?

CALLEE

I am the President of India, go ahead and google my name.

ANIRUDH

Hey, you better fix your attitude. Your father is in deep legal trouble and here you are trying to be funny?

CALLEE

Oh really? What kind of legal trouble is he in?

ANIRUDH

I think you didn't get me. This is Inspector Vijaya from NBI, Cybercrimes Division. We need to contact your father regarding a case that we believe he is involved in.

CALLEE

Trust me I got you the very first time itself. Usually, I don't entertain fools like you but right now, I am intrigued. Please enlighten me on what kind of case is my dad involved in.

ANIRUDH

I am not obliged to share case details with you. But if you don't cooperate I will absolutely book you for interfering with a sensitive investigation involving National Security.

CALLEE

(Laughs loudly)

Go ahead, book me moron! Book me for terrorism instead and let me see what you are capable of.

ANIRUDH

(Getting angry)

Okay, wait and watch. It will take me minutes to find out your name from the records of your father. I am registering a case against you for interfering with an official investigation and obstructing a government officer. There will be a warrant out for your arrest soon along with your father. Then we will talk in person and see if you are still funny.

CALLEE

LOL! How thrilling! I am now the most wanted man in India just for being funny.

ANIRUDH

A silly reason to go in prison.
All you had to do was cooperate
with us. I am sure I will find
your name in some other cases, all
of which will be reopened now.

CALLEE

Great and I am sure I will find
your name on Only Fans. How much
you sell for? 20 Rs?

ANIRUDH

(Very angry)

Okay idiot! You have crossed the
line. I will make sure that you
regret it for the rest of your
life.

CALLEE

Alright man. Go ahead, do whatever
you want. But that's all the time
I got for a clown like you. So now
please go and bother someone else
instead.

ANIRUDH

We are not done yet...

Call disconnects abruptly cutting Anirudh off. He mutters
something to himself angrily while shaking his fist. He gets
up and walks for a minute to release his frustration. Then
returns to his workstation to mark the lead as failed. Checks
another lead and hesitates for some time. His phone suddenly
rings, with Caller ID: Supervisor Sir.

[Scene Note - Background Event]

[A strange hand is barely visible coming from behind an
obstacle at a distance outside the window. Protagonist does
not notice it or reacts to it. It is framed in a way that
it's really hard to notice it. Stays for a few shots before
disappearing. Always at the side or at the corner of the
frame.]

SUPERVISOR

Hello Anirudh.

ANIRUDH

Yes, hello sir.

SUPERVISOR

I was reviewing your last call.
What happened? You lost your cool
too soon.

ANIRUDH

He already knew, sir. It was out
of my hands.

SUPERVISOR

No Anirudh. Your approach was not correct. When he mentioned it's the son you should change tactics and find some reason to call back later or convince him to give phone to his father. But instead you doubled down on threats. You cannot lose your cool like this.

ANIRUDH

I understand sir. I will try my best.

SUPERVISOR

Don't sabotage leads like this. If you can't handle let us know. There is no shortage of people who want to do this.

ANIRUDH

No no, sir. And I promise I will be more careful.

SUPERVISOR

Consider this your final warning. You may continue.

ANIRUDH

Yes sir.

Anirudh takes a deep breath and starts calling the numbers. Call Montage begins.

INT. ROOFTOP ROOM - MIDDLE OF THE NIGHT

Anirudh looks at the Sheet and notices that there have been some modifications on it. He notices that some of the previous leads he had spoken to and marked as Collection in Progress have a strange note "DECEASED" next to them. He does not remember putting those.

ANIRUDH

What is this? When did I ever write this?

He scrolls up and down the sheet. He is confused.

INT. ROOFTOP ROOM - LATE NIGHT

Anirudh looks at the final entry in the Sheet. It says Anirudh G. He is shocked. He picks up his phone and calls his manager.

ANIRUDH

Hello sir.

SUPERVISOR

Yes Anirudh, what is it?

ANIRUDH

Sir, why is my name on this list?

SUPERVISOR

What do you mean? Why would your name be there in the list?

ANIRUDH

Sir, it says Anirudh G and has what looks like my number.

SUPERVISOR

So, you are telling me you are the only Anirudh G on the whole planet.

ANIRUDH

No sir, but it looks like my name and number.

SUPERVISOR

Why don't you call it and find out?

ANIRUDH

Sir, I have bad feeling about this.

SUPERVISOR

Listen, do me a favour. Just call all leads and submit the report. I don't have time for this.

ANIRUDH

Please sir, really strange things are happening. I am really scared.

SUPERVISOR

(Voice getting Garbled)
Anirudh just finish the list...
You need to finish the list...

ANIRUDH

What sir?

Call disconnects.

ANIRUDH

Hello? Hello?

Anirudh puts the phone down.

PHONE
(Garbled Voice)
Finish the list

ANIRUDH
What the fuck? What was that?

Scared, he looks around the room and the door. He gets up, picks up the door key and goes near the door. He tries opening but sees that the lock is on the other side of the door. He realizes he is trapped in the room.

ANIRUDH
Oh crap. What do I do? What the fuck!

Anirudh picks up his phone and dials Emergency number. Someone picks up on the other side.

SUPERVISOR
Hello, Anirudh? Why are you calling me again? Are you done with the list?

ANIRUDH
What? No sir! I didn't call you. I called Emergency no.

SUPERVISOR
Are you out of your mind? Why did you call Emergency? Something stupid going on in your mind?

ANIRUDH
No Sir! I am trapped in my room. I need help sir. I don't know what to do!

SUPERVISOR
(Voice getting Garbled)
I told you to finish the List...
Just finish the List...

Anirudh hangs up. He grabs his head in distress. He slowly approaches his PC. Then opens the dialer and types in the number. Hesitantly presses Dial.

Silence hangs for 15-20 seconds. Then his personal phone starts ringing. Caller ID says Unknown Number. Anirudh slowly picks up.

ANIRUDH
Hel...Hello?

VOICE
Hello, this is Inspector Vijaya
Speaking from the Cybercrime
Division of National Bureau of
(MORE)

VOICE (CONT'D)
Investigation. Am I speaking to
Mr. Anirudh?

ANIRUDH
(Panicking)
What? Who is this.

VOICE
This is Inspector Vijaya, I have
been assigned to your case file
regarding...

ANIRUDH
No no no, this is not possible.
This cannot be possible.

Anirudh drops his phone. Entities enter his room. Anirudh
hides.

VOICE
Hello sir, am I audible? Hello?

Entities surround Anirudh, camera fades.

FADE OUT.